...y clerk. I did not know Kelly had ...ed a statement nor contemplated ...a course until I was so advised ...Council Bluffs over the long dis... telephone by Sheriff Meyers of ...

...knew before I left Logan, how... ...as stated above, that Kelly had ...ssed to the crime and had related ...various details thereof. Reports as ...third degree" methods employed ...absolutely false.

...elly has come clean. I am con... ...of his guilt and have the evi... to back it up. His confession ...talls with every circumstance ...rounding the murder and clears up ...most remote details. So far as we ...concerned, the trial will start at ...Oak, Sept. 4th. We are ready."

Makes Other Confessions

...r. Havner announced Saturday ...Kelly had also confessed that he ...ed the fires that destroyed a num... ...of buildings in Sutton, Nebraska, ...1915.

Wife Says Kelly Denies

...rs. Kelly, wife of the accused ...n, who is at Logan, told a repres... ...ative of The Omaha World-Herald ...t her husband declared to her Fri... ...y night that the alleged confession ...s a pure fabrication. He admitted ...ming it, but said he did not know ...y he did so, as not a word of it was ...e.

Kelly Gives Himself Up

...An indictment was returned against ...lly by a Montgomery county grand ...y on Monday night, April 30, at ...out eleven o'clock, but the accused ...s not arrested until he appeared in ...d Oak on Monday morning, May 14, ...d gave himself up. Kelly, in com... ...ny with his wife and his attorney, ...dge A. L. Sutton of Omaha, arrived ...the county seat about six o'clock ...om the east on passenger train num... ...r five. They walked around town ...r an hour or so, ate breakfast and ...en went to the court house where ...lly was to surrender himself to the ...eriff. However, Sheriff Dunn came ...er to Villisca that morning and was ...sent from his office when the party ...lled. They then went to the office ...County Attorney Wenstrand, made ...eir business known and the latter ...t in touch over the telephone with ...e sheriff who returned to Red Oak ...ortly after noon and made the ar... ...st. Kelly was placed in the Red Oak ...ll without bond, first degree murder ...ing an offense that does not admit ...bail.

Some of the Evidence

Following the arrest of Kelly, At...rney General Havner gave out the ...llowing statement which includes some of the evidence that is responsible for the indictment against the preacher:

"Lynn George J. Kelly, the man indicted for the murder of the J. B Moore family and Stillinger girls at Villisca, was born in England and came to this country about ten years ago. At the time that the crime was committed Kelly was a student and in attendance on a theological seminary at Omaha. Kelly was preaching at Macedonia, Iowa, and at a small country church near Villisca on alternate Sundays

"About three weeks before the crime was committed in June, 1912 a reputable witness testified that Kelly was discovered looking into the house of the witness, in a bedroom where the wife of the witness was moving about the room in her night clothes, and on being called Kelly ran towards his residence It was also testified to that Kelly would be seen about town at all hours of the night wandering, apparently, aimlessly about

"On the night that the crime was committed Kelly came from his country charge to the town of Villisca and attended a children's day exercise at the Presbyterian church at the evening service, in the city of Villisca. After the evening service he went to the home of the Presbyterian minister and was shown to his hoom at about 10:30 or 11 o'clock The minister and his family slept in a tent in the back yard. The minister testifies that it was the arrangement with Kelly that Kelly was to get up in the morning and take the 5 19 train to his home at Macedonia The minister and his wife testified that they do not know what time Kelly got up, and all that they know is that he was gone when they got up in the morning, which was at quite a late hour

The Case Against Kelly

"Between 8:30 and 9 o'clock on the following morning (Monday) a reputable witness testifies that Kelly told him in Macedonia the details of the murder at Villisca and of the number of people that had been killed, and this witness also testifies that Kelly told him at that time that he (Kelly) had been unable to sleep during the previous night and had gone out on the balcony of the house where he was staying at about 1 o'clock at night and had heard the thud of the ax that killed the Moore people and that he was one of the first men in the house after the murder was discovered. The facts are that the murders were not discovered until about 8:30 or 9 o'clock and that nobody but the man who committed the crime ever knew how the murders were committed.

"Another reputable witness testified that at a later date Kelly told him that he heard the thud of the ax that killed the Moore people and that the man who committed the murder went to the house about 1 o'clock and while he was in the house he heard some one going along the street; that the murderer went out on the back porch until the parties had passed the house and then went back in and finished the job.

"Within two or three days after the crime was committed, a package of laundry was left with the Bluff City laundry in Council Bluffs without any name being left or any identifying mark put on it, but with a slip appended requesting that the shirt be placed in the basket of laundry to be returned to Macedonia. The girl who unwrapped the laundry says that there was a shirt in the package that had been evidently washed, or an attempt had been made to wash it by hand, for it was still quite moist and appeared to be saturated with blood. This laundry was sent back in the Macedonia basket unmarked, and Kelly came to the drug store where the basket was received and claimed this laundry. He had made several trips to the drug store for it before it came.

"About a week after the murders were committed Kelly wrote a letter to the Presbyterian minister asking that arrangements be made for him (Kelly) to inspect the Moore house when he was in Villisca the next time (which would be the second Sunday following the murder). On this visit to Villisca Kelly stayed with the minister again and occupied an upstairs bedroom in the house, as formerly, and the testimony of the minister's wife is that no one could have gone from the house on this occasion without awakening them.

Wrote to Ross Moore

"On the twelfth day of July, 1912, Kelly wrote a letter to Ross Moore, brother of the murdered man, and among other things said that there was a strange man at the depot that morning who spoke to him and who he believed got on the same train with him. In his letter he stated that he was almost sure to a certainty that this was the man who committed the murder. He (Kelly) in this letter stated that this strange man was up and down the streets of Villisca on Friday and Saturday nights until 4 o'clock, and that he asked a certain party whom Kelly knew about the Presbyterian church, and that he was down by the river on Sunday and stayed there on Saturday night.

"He also says in his letter that the man was seen about the streets on Sunday night (just preceding the murder) at 10 o'clock, and also states, 'He was seen again running to the river between one and two. A young couple passed the house at 1:30, but saw and heard nothing.' Kelly also described in this letter a trip which he claims to have taken in the night on the second Sunday following the murder down to the Moore home, and describes the sensations that came to him. Kelly also made the request that he be given an opportunity to work on the case.

"Kelly continued in his pastorate at Macedonia for some time after the murder, and witnesses testify that at every opportunity he constantly talked about the murder. Late in the fall he surrendered his position as pastor at Macedonia and at the small charge near Villisca and went to Carroll, Iowa, where he took up work there. Carroll witnesses state that he commenced talking about the Villisca ax murder there also and would say that he had been accused of the murder.

Asks Girl to Pose in Nude

"Witnesses testified that shortly after he went to Carroll he advertised for a class in stenography, and that he tried to get young girls to pose in the nude. While he was at Carroll he told one man that he was accused of this crime and asked him what he should do. Told him that he was suspected because he had not used his bed that night and that the reason he didn't go to bed was because he was nervous, and that he went down to the depot about an hour before his train and took the early morning train.

"He talked with other people at Carroll, among them a physician, who says that Kelly asked him whether a man who committed a murder could be punished if he was insane, and that the physician told him that he could not.

"The testimony of many witnesses is that Kelly seemed to be suspicious of every stranger he would see about town and would make inquiry as to whether or not they were detectives. He also asked the physician how a man would act who was insane. He also explained the shirt proposition by saying that he had gotten hair tonic on it, and at another time stated that the stain was catsup.

Arrested by Uncle Sam

"After he left Carroll, which was some time in 1913, he went to Winner, South Dakota. While at Winner he did preaching and evangelistic work, and also stenographic work. He then ran an ad in the Omaha World-Herald seeking to employ a stenographer to act as model for pictures to be used in a book which he was writing. A young lady at Council Bluffs answered the ad and Kelly answered her letter in such a way that the young lady turned it over to her pastor and the pastor in turn notified the United States authorities at Council Bluffs. Afterwards the federal authorities ordered Kelly's arrest at Winner. When placed under arrest he remarked to the officers that he knew they were going to take him, that they wanted him in Villisca for the murders there and when he was informed that he was not being arrested for that crime, but for sending obscene matter through the mails he denied having anything to do with that matter, but when confronted with the letters he admitted having writen them. He threatened violence to the officers at different times while in custody.

"Kelly was then taken from Winner to Sioux Falls where he was placed in jail. While in the jail at Sioux Falls he was guilty of a number of revolting immoral acts attempted on fellow prisoners. He admitted to several officers when questioned that he had committed the ax murder at Villisca and that he would like to do the same thing to the officers. When questioned about the immorality attempted in the jail he replied that that was nothing. He was extremely profane and irritable, and gave the authorities a great

(Continued on Page Seven).

GUESTS IN THE J. B. MOORE HOME



LENA STILLINGER, age 11



INA STILLINGER, age 8

Special Special

We have sold our stock of clothing, giving possession Monday, September 10, 1917. So this is our last week in business at this place.

Come In And We Will Give You Some Bargains In Clothing and Furnishings

Everything this last week must be cash. Also all of our out-standing accounts must be settled. If you owe us please come in and pay same or make arrangements for it. Do YOU owe us? If you don't remember, watch this space next week; will your name be there?

We thank our friends for their patronage and are sure very sorry that we can not stay.
BUT, Gile is going to France.

BOWERS & GILE, Villisca, Ia.